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(b) Explain the basic features of 'Postmodernism' in Anthropology

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Post modernism is an anthropological theory emerged in late 20th century which challenged the existing ~~the~~ anthropological theories.

Chief proponents - Jacques Derrida, Michael Foucault.

They challenged the theories on grounds

- Fieldwork conducted
- literary tradition
- anthropological perspective.

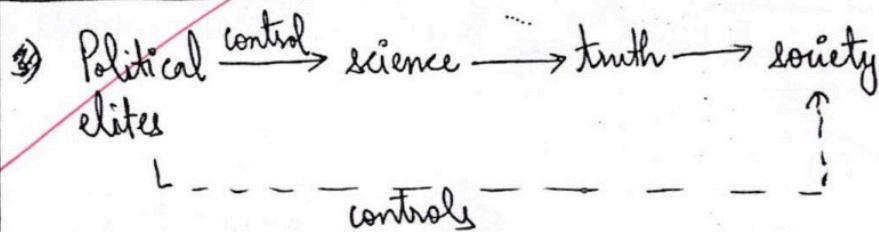
Key concepts

1) As per post modernist, the reality is plural hence a single explanation to reality is not true.

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2) They also challenged the ethnography done by the anthropologists. They argued it is subjective hence objectivity can never be achieved.



Post modernist view

3) They argued that since, society is based on facts & truth. Truth is established by science which in turn is controlled by political elites. Hence, deconstruct is needed.

4) As per post modernists, society is indirectly controlled by few through their control on media and science.

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Types of Post-modernists

Skeptics

- complete rejection of anthropological theories
- eg: Derrida

Affirmatives

- reforms are needed in existing theories
- eg: Michael Foucault

Methodology used

deconstruction

inuitive interpretation

Criticism

- 1) Spino argued that anthropology will remain empirical as long as it study the effect of causes

- 2) Bob Mckinley (2000) post modernism more of a religion than science.

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3) Ray Andrade - anthropology as a subject contains ethnographic objectivity and is in no way dehumanising.

Despite criticism, post modernists shifted the focus of anthropology towards ethnographic techniques which resulted in various modifications.

